

I asked the matron why there were so few men. She looked at me suspiciously. "You really want to know?"

I nodded, not at all sure I really did.

She said, "Women come here to live. Men come here to die."

When today's old people were my age, the idea of living to work was coming into its own. Vance Packard's 1959 study *The Status Seekers* (McKay) glorified and exposed the ad world and the ugly side of corporate life. William Whyte wrote *The Organization Man* (Simon & Schuster) in 1957. Whyte's story now has its terrible final chapter. When the organization man can't work, he has no reason to live.

Having seen what lies ahead of you when you hang up your boots—or when you're forced out at age 55—do you still think you need more money before you can afford to retire *now*? Why wait for golden years you may not live to enjoy? Maybe you can't afford *not* to retire now.

HERE'S THE FORMULA

Part 1 of this book reveals the formula that can turn your retirement dream into a here-and-now reality. The formula has three parts. First, you'll find out how much money you need, how to invest, and how to spend. Next, you'll see how to kick the work habit. Finally, you'll get some ideas about what's out there and how to get started in your new life. Follow the formula and you'll never snooze through lukewarm coffee and bad cognac at your retirement dinner.

The rules you need to follow aren't conventional; neither is retiring after only ten or fifteen years of work. But they're simple rules, far more simple than the rules you've followed up to now. I've set out the rules in big block letters so you won't miss them. The three-part formula in part 1 is: